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Purpose

This policy defines how long business records are kept and when they must be deleted.

Scope

This document applies to employees based in Germany. It is owned by John Whitehead and is effective from 2025-12-06.

Policy Rules

Financial records are kept for 10 years.

Employee records are kept for 6 years after the employment ends.

Customer support tickets are deleted 12 months after they are closed.

Records under a legal hold must not be deleted until legal releases the hold.

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Procedure

1. Identify the record type in the retention schedule.
2. Check whether a legal hold applies.
3. Delete the record using the approved deletion tool.
4. Log the deletion in the records register.

Escalation

Questions about whether a record may be deleted are sent to the legal team.

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Contacts

Send questions about this document by email to legal-help@company.local.

Document Control

Under Data Retention Policy (Germany) (version 4), the standard limit is 180 days. This is the maximum number of days between two checks of the document by its owner.

Version 4 replaces version 3. Values and thresholds were revised in the latest yearly check.